10-04 第1篇

阅读理解（议论文） Should Middle-School Students Do Regular Housework at Home?

① Last weekend a friend's mother complained on WeChat: "My son is 14. He can solve hard maths problems, but he cannot fold his own quilt." The message got many likes. Under the message, a heated debate began: **should middle-school students do regular housework at home — or should they be allowed to focus completely on studying?** I believe regular housework is not a waste of time; it is, in fact, one of the most useful "extra subjects" a middle-school student can take.

② First, housework teaches **real responsibility**. A textbook can say that a family is a small team, but only washing the family's dishes twice a week can make a student feel it. When you wipe the table, you see the oil left by a tiring dinner your mother made; when you hang up the clothes, you notice how often your grandfather's shirts are washed. These small discoveries turn the word "family" from a word into something you actually carry on your hands.

③ Second, housework builds **useful life skills**. Many parents complain that their children "cannot even boil water". Whose fault is this? If we learn to sweep floors, sort clothes by colour, cook simple rice, and wash a bathroom at fourteen, we will not panic when we first live in a dormitory, a rented flat, or our own home. School teaches us physics and history; home should teach us how to live.

④ Third, regular housework is **good for health**. Many middle-school students now sit for eight hours a day at school and then go home to sit for another three hours of homework. Fifteen minutes of sweeping, mopping or tidying is not just a chore — it is a natural break, a simple exercise and a rest for the tired eyes. A student who tidies his own desk for five minutes before bed often sleeps better.

⑤ Of course, **critics worry about time**. They say middle-school students already wake at 6:30 and finish homework after 10 p.m.; adding housework simply means losing sleep. This worry is real. But the answer is **smart housework**, not heavy housework: maybe twenty minutes a day, not two hours. Setting the table before dinner, washing your own dishes, putting clothes away — these tasks can be done while waiting for the rice cooker, or during a commercial break of a favourite show. Twenty minutes a day is less than one extra short-video session.

⑥ Another worry is **that parents do housework better and faster**. This is true. If speed is the only goal, a middle-school student should of course not mop the floor — a mother can do it in half the time. But the goal of housework at this age is **not speed**; it is

practice. A student who cracks his first egg on the floor today will crack a hundred perfect ones in his twenties. Children learn slowly. If we do not let them start at fourteen, when will they start?

⑦ A third worry is **fairness**. Why, some students ask, should I carry a heavy schoolbag *and* clean the bathroom? This question deserves an honest answer: housework is **shared**, not dumped. Parents should not use "life education" as an excuse to free themselves; students should not use "study" as an excuse to do nothing. A fair family divides tasks: perhaps cooking is the parents', washing dishes is the student's; perhaps weekend cleaning is done together with music playing and a big pot of tea.

⑧ There is also a deeper point. Many students today receive love mainly as **service**: meals cooked, clothes washed, shoes wiped, bags carried. If they never once return the same service, they quietly learn that love is something they *receive*, not something they *give*. A 14-year-old who sweeps the living room for his grandmother has, in a few minutes, learned more about love than any essay could teach.

⑨ My conclusion is simple. Middle-school students should do, on average, **about twenty minutes of housework a day** — small, regular, shared with the family. Schools might help by setting one "home-work of the week" task: peel five apples, or wash a week's socks. Parents should resist the temptation to do everything themselves. Housework will not turn a student into a scholar; but it will turn a student into **a grown-up**, which, in the end, is also what education is for.

注释： housework 家务；chore 琐事；dormitory 宿舍；commercial break 广告时段；peel 削皮

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What is the writer's main view in this essay?

A. Middle-school students should never do housework.
B. Middle-school students should do regular but limited housework at home — it is a valuable "extra subject".
C. Only the youngest child in a family should do housework.
D. Housework is far more important than studying.

2. According to Paragraph 2, how does housework help a student understand family?

A. It gives the student money.
B. By doing small tasks, a student notices details of other members' lives and turns the word "family" into something felt on his own hands.
C. It allows the student to command others.
D. It helps the student stay away from family.

3. In Paragraph 5, how does the writer reply to the worry that students have no time?

A. He says students should give up sleeping.
B. He suggests "smart housework": about twenty minutes a day, done in small moments like waiting for the rice cooker.
C. He says students should stop doing homework.
D. He says parents should do nothing at all.

4. What does the writer mean in Paragraph 6 by "the goal of housework at this age is not speed; it is practice"?

A. Students should work as slowly as possible to waste time.
B. Parents should always do housework because they are faster, and students should never try.
C. At 14, the point of housework is to **learn** through practice, even if it is slower than what parents could do.
D. Practice means students must be exactly as fast as their mothers.

5. Which of the following is closest to the writer's overall message?

A. Housework is a magic cure for poor grades.
B. Housework, shared and regular, helps a student grow into a capable and caring adult — and that is also part of education.
C. Housework is only for girls, not boys.
D. Families with a maid should never let children help.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨/观点题
【定位】第①段 "regular housework ... one of the most useful 'extra subjects' a middle-school student can take"；第⑨段 "about twenty minutes of housework a day ... small, regular, shared"
【解析】作者主张适度规律做家务。A、C、D 均与原文立场不符。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "these small discoveries turn the word 'family' from a word into something you actually carry on your hands."
【解析】通过小事发现家人的付出，对"家"有切身体会。A "给钱"、C "发号施令"、D "远离家人"均与原文相反。故选 B。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤段 "the answer is smart housework, not heavy housework: maybe twenty minutes a day ... while waiting for the rice cooker"
【解析】作者提倡"小而巧"。A、C、D 均非作者观点。故选 B。

4.
【答案】C
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】第⑥段 "A student who cracks his first egg on the floor today will crack a hundred perfect ones in his twenties. Children learn slowly."
【解析】作者强调练习过程比完成速度重要。A、B、D 均为错解或极端化。故选 C。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨/观点题
【定位】第⑧⑨段 "love is something they give ... turn a student into a grown-up, which ... is also what education is for."
【解析】家务让学生成长为有能力、有关爱的成年人。A 夸大、C 性别化、D 与原文立场相反。故选 B。